

The Crew

Travel Together to the 9th Planet

3-5 players ages 10 and up

Components

- 40 game cards (larger)
 - 1-9 in 4 color suits
 - 1-4 in the rocket suit (trump)
- 36 task cards (smaller)
 - 1-9 in 4 color suits
- 5 reminder cards
- 10 task priority tiles
- 5 radio tiles
- 1 distress signal tile
- 1 commander marker
- 1 mission log

Overview

The Crew is a cooperative trick-taking game in which players work together to complete mission objectives. Players must sequentially work their way through 50 prescribed missions to win the game. Progress is tracked in the mission log, allowing the game to be completed over multiple sittings. Alternatively, players may decide to pick and choose the missions they play instead of playing through the entire campaign.

Game Flow

The Crew has much in common with traditional trick-taking games. At the beginning of each mission, the deck of 40 **game cards** is shuffled and dealt to each of the players (in a 3-player game one player is dealt an extra card). Next, the **mission log** is consulted to determine what the current mission objectives and restrictions are. This will be described in detail later. Finally, play begins.

Card play follows standard Whist rules. The player who has the **4 of rockets** in their hand is the **commander** and leads the first trick. The player who leads a trick may play any card they like. The other players must play a card in the same suit as the card that was led if they are able and may play any card if they cannot. The highest rocket card played wins the trick. If no rockets were played, the trick is won by the highest card played in the led suit. The player who won the trick collects all the cards that were played, and places them facedown in a personal trick pile before leading the next trick.

If at any point during the mission either all the objectives are archived or one of the objectives fails, the mission immediately ends. Everything is reset to either move on to the next mission or attempt the current mission again. When a mission is successfully completed, the number of times it was attempted should be recorded in the mission log. If a mission is skipped due to repeat failures, record 10 attempts for the skipped mission.

Communication

Players may never reveal any information about the cards that they hold in their hand. The only exception to this rule is by using the **radio tile**. Once per mission, each player may place a card from their hand faceup on the table in front of them, and then position a radio tile, green-side up, on top of the card to communicate information about the suit of the card as follows:

- **Top** of the card indicates that it's the highest card they hold in the suit
- **Middle** of the card indicates that it's the only card they hold in the suit
- **Bottom** of the card indicates that it's the lowest card they hold in the suit

The revealed card is treated as if it were still in the player's hand. After placing the card, they add a **reminder card** to their hand, so that they don't forget about the card on the table. When they play the revealed card to a trick, they also remove the reminder card from their hand and turn their radio

tile to the red-side to indicate that it can no longer be used.

The following restrictions apply:

- If a card is not the highest, lowest, or only card in that suit in your hand, then it cannot be revealed
- Once the radio tile has been placed it may not be adjusted later
- Rockets may never be communicated
- Communication is only allowed before a trick has started; never during
- Communication is not allowed before task tiles are assigned

Distress Signal

Once per mission the group may decide to activate the **distress signal**. It may only be activated immediately before the first trick (after card and task distribution) and before any players have communicated. Once active, the distress signal is turned facedown and remains in effect for the current mission attempt and all future attempts of the same mission. It is reset at the start of the next mission.

Without communicating, each player selects one game card to simultaneously pass facedown to their neighbor. Rocket cards may never be passed. The group must decide together if the cards are passed to the right or to the left. After the pass, the commander leads the first trick as normal. If the distress signal was activated on a prior mission attempt, players are not required to pass a card at the start of a new attempt, but either everyone passes or no one does.

Activating the distress signal increases the number of mission attempts by one.

Missions

Every mission is different. The objectives and restrictions for each mission are described in the

mission log. A mission will always have a **commander**, who is the player who is dealt the **4 of rockets**. The following are descriptions of the various types of objectives that can be part of a mission.

Tasks

When a mission includes tasks, after the game cards are dealt and before play begins, the **task deck** is shuffled, and as many task cards as the mission specifies are placed faceup in the center of the table. The commander must select one of these cards, placing it faceup in front of themselves. Going clockwise around the table, each of the other players selects a task card until there are no tasks remaining. Communication is not allowed. Some players may have more tasks than others.

A task card obligates the player who it is assigned to to take the game card depicted on the task in a trick. If the specified card is taken by any other player, the mission fails. It is possible for a player to complete multiple tasks in a single trick. When a task is complete, the corresponding task card should be turned facedown.

Task Priority Tiles

Task priority tiles impose restrictions on the order that tasks must be completed. When a mission uses priority tiles, it specifies which tiles must be used. After revealing the mission's task cards, sequentially place a tile on each of the task cards in the order that they were revealed. Every task card may not have a tile. When a player takes a task, they also take its tile with it.

All tasks must be completed in the order specified by their associated tiles. If a task is completed out of order, the mission fails. The tiles are as follows:

- **1:** Must be the 1st task completed
- **2:** Must be the 2nd task completed
- **3:** Must be the 3rd task completed
- **4:** Must be the 4th task completed
- **5:** Must be the 5th task completed

- >: Must be completed before the >> task
- >>: Must be completed between the > and >>> tasks
- >>>: Must be completed between the >> and >>>> tasks
- >>>>: Must be completed after the >>>> task
- Ω: Must be the final task completed

The numbered tiles are more restrictive than the relative tiles because any task that does not have a number tile assigned may only be completed after all the numbered tasks are complete. While, the relative tiles allow tasks without an assigned priority tile to be completed at any point.

If multiple tasks are completed in the same trick and their tiles are sequential, then they are considered successful.

Radio Interference

In some missions, communication is restricted due to **radio interference**. Players are still allowed to communicate, but the information is not as precise. All the normal communication rules apply except that the radio tile is placed red-side up next to the card rather than on top of it. The revealed card must be the highest, lowest, or only card the player holds in the suit, but they must not indicate which.

Communication Disruption

When communication is **disrupted**, no communication is allowed at all until the start of a specified trick. From that trick on, players may communicate as normal.

Solo Task Assignment

Sometimes the commander must select a single player who is responsible for completing every task. This happens immediately after the tasks are revealed. The commander may not select themselves, and the other players may not influence their decision.

Group Task Assignment

When a mission specifies **group task assignment**, the mission's tasks are not displayed in the center of the table as normal. Instead, the commander reveals tasks one by one, assigning each task before revealing the next. After revealing a task, going clockwise around the table, each player must indicate with a "yes" or "no" if they are interested in the task. The commander then assigns the task to any player, including themselves. If the mission also includes task priority tiles, remember to pass these out in order along with the task cards. The tasks must be evenly distributed. After all the tasks are assigned, no player may have 2 or more tasks than another player.

5-Player Rules

The rules for playing with 5 players are the same. However, because the 5-player game is more challenging, in certain missions before the first trick begins, one player is permitted to transfer one of their tasks to another player. The transfer should be discussed as a group first. Missions that allow transfers are marked in the mission log with a gold star, starting with mission 25.

Hints & Tips

- It is usually easier to win cards that you do not hold in your hand, especially low ones.
- Rocket cards make it easy to win cards in suits that you do not have.
- The 4 of rockets will always win a trick.
- Try to complete multiple tasks in the same trick.
- When you only hold the 8 and 9 of a suit, communicate the 8 so that everyone knows you also hold the 9.